✦ METALS MADE SIMPLE SERIES ✦

FREE GUIDE · BOOK COMPANION RESOURCE

The 5-Step Metals Privacy Checklist

What to think through before you buy your first coin — so you start smart, stay private, and avoid the mistakes most new buyers make

WORK THROUGH THESE 5 STEPS BEFORE YOUR FIRST PURCHASE. THEY TAKE MINUTES. THE MISTAKES THEY PREVENT CAN BE COSTLY.

> *One of the most common things I hear from metals buyers is "I wish I had known this before I started." These five steps are designed to help you think through the key decisions in advance — so your first purchase is one you feel confident about.*

1
STEP

KNOW WHY YOU ARE BUYING

This sounds simple but it is the most overlooked step. Are you buying to **protect your wealth** from a declining dollar? As a **long-term store of value?** For potential barter in an uncertain future? For **privacy** reasons? As part of a diversified portfolio? Your answer should have a direct influence on what types of metals you buy, in what quantities, and in what form. Someone buying for privacy has different needs than someone buying purely for investment returns.

ASK YOURSELF *If I had to explain to someone why I am buying precious metals, what would I say? That answer is your guide to everything that follows.*

2
STEP

PLAN HOW YOU WILL SELL — BEFORE YOU BUY

Most buyers spend all their time thinking about what to buy and very little time thinking about how they will eventually sell. This is a mistake. **The type of metal you buy today directly determines how privately — and how easily — you can sell it tomorrow.** Metals prices can move quickly. If you ever need or want to liquidate at the right moment, being locked into metals that require reporting or have limited buyers could cost you the opportunity. Deciding your exit strategy in advance is one of the most practical things you can do.

ASK YOURSELF *When I am ready to sell — whether that is in 2 years or 20 — how do I want that transaction to look? Private or not? All at once or over time?*

3
STEP

UNDERSTAND THE PRIVACY RULES BEFORE YOU BUY

Privacy in metals investing is entirely legal — but it requires knowing the rules in advance. **Not all metals are treated equally when it comes to IRS reporting requirements.** Certain coins can be bought and sold in any quantity with no reporting required. Others trigger a Form 1099-B above certain thresholds. How you pay also matters — cash purchases over $10,000 trigger a separate reporting requirement that has nothing to do with the metals themselves. Understanding these distinctions before your first purchase — not after — puts you in complete control.

KEY POINT *See the Private Metals Cheat Sheet (Guide 1 in this bundle) for the complete at-a-glance breakdown of which metals are private and which are not.*

4
STEP

CHOOSE THE RIGHT FORM OF METAL FOR YOUR GOALS

Gold, silver, coins, bars, rounds, junk silver — the options can feel overwhelming. But once you are clear on your goals from Steps 1 and 2, the choice becomes much simpler. **Government-minted bullion coins** (American Eagles, Gold Buffalos, Silver Maple Leafs, etc.) offer the broadest combination of privacy, liquidity, and ease of buying and selling. They are recognized worldwide, easy to price, and straightforward to resell. Other forms can be perfectly fine — but they come with tradeoffs worth understanding before you commit.

WORTH KNOWING *The form of metal you choose today affects your privacy, your flexibility, and your ability to sell at the time and price you want. It is worth taking the time to choose intentionally.*

5
STEP

DECIDE HOW YOU WILL PAY — BEFORE YOU WALK IN

Your purchase of precious metals is never reported to the IRS — regardless of how much you buy or what type of metal you choose. However, **how you pay is a separate matter.** Cash purchases over $10,000 (including money orders and cashier's checks) trigger a Form 8300 cash transaction report — not a metals report, but a cash report. Paying by personal check or bank wire avoids this requirement entirely and keeps your transaction completely off the radar. Knowing this in advance — and making a simple decision about payment method — takes this issue completely off the table.

SIMPLE SOLUTION *For most buyers, paying by personal check or bank wire is the simplest way to keep a metals purchase completely private from start to finish.*

YOUR 5-STEP QUICK REFERENCE

1	KNOW WHY YOU'RE BUYING
2	PLAN YOUR EXIT FIRST
3	LEARN THE PRIVACY RULES
4	CHOOSE THE RIGHT METAL
5	DECIDE HOW YOU'LL PAY

READY TO TAKE THE NEXT STEP?

Buy Your First Metals at 7–10% Below What Most Investors Pay

Once you have worked through these 5 steps, the next question is where to buy. After 30 years in this market I found a dealer that sells at **actual dealer cost** — not inflated retail. Members consistently save **7–10%** compared to virtually everywhere else. For a first-time buyer, that difference adds up immediately.

METALSMADESIMPLE.COM/SAVE

No obligation. No pressure. Compare their pricing to anyone — you will see it right away.

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